

Final Essay Task 1

MENDOZA, JAHN LORENCE A

BSCS - C302

1. What are the four primary factors that will differentiate a data analyst candidate in 2026?

- The four factors are domain knowledge, understanding the tech environment, good communication skills, and having a clear reason or goal. These are important because they show you can do more than just use tools. They help you stand out from other applicants.

2. How does domain knowledge provide a competitive advantage over purely technical candidates?

- Domain knowledge helps you understand how a business works and what data is important. Because of this, you can give better and more useful insights. Technical candidates may know tools but not how to use them in real situations.

3. What is the “lean tech stack” recommended for a foundational data analyst role?

- The lean tech stack includes Excel, SQL, and a visualization tool like Tableau or Power BI. These tools are enough to do basic data analysis and create reports. You don't need to learn too many tools at the start.

4. Distinguish between “learning projects” and “showing projects”

-Learning projects are for practice and usually use simple and clean data. Showing projects are more serious and use real, messy data to solve problems. They also show your skills in explaining and presenting results.

5. According to the roadmap, why is Python often deprioritized for mid-career data analyst positions?

-Python is not always needed because it is not used often in daily tasks. It is also not usually tested in interviews. Other tools like SQL and dashboards are more useful for analysts.

6. Why is establishing the “Business Context” essential for an analyst? What is a Business Context?

- Business context means knowing the goal or problem of the business. It is important because it helps you understand what to analyze. Without it, your work might not be helpful.

7. According to the text, how does SQL function as a “flashlight”?

- SQL is like a flashlight because it helps you find and explore data. It lets you focus on the important parts. This makes it easier to understand the data.

8. Why is the validation step considered a professional necessity rather than an optional task?

- Validation is important to make sure your results are correct. If your data is wrong, it can lead to bad decisions. That’s why checking your work is needed.

9. What defines “good SQL” according to the author’s standards?

- Good SQL is simple, clear, and easy to read. It should be organized and correct. It should not be too complicated.

10. Describe the fundamental mindset shift required to move from being a student to being an analyst.

- The mindset changes from just studying to solving real problems. An analyst uses data to help a business make decisions. It also means thinking more and explaining your answers clearly.